

AI FOR IMPACT · BOSTON LXP 2026

DAY 2

SESSION 2 · WORKSHOP DAY

AI Use & Implementation

Solution Design & Prototyping

Instructor: Deepak Sathyanarayan | Eigen Strategic Systems

International
& Digital
Business School



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Today's objectives

Every team produces the same artifacts:

A Solution Spec, workflow mock-up, UI prototype, and backend prototype.

- **Map AI capabilities to your problem:** Pick the AI architecture that is appropriate to the work.
- **Design the user journey end-to-end:** Inputs, outputs, where AI sits, what the non-AI baseline looks like.
- **Prototype & experiment together:** UI workflow, UI prototype, Backend prototype.
- **Defend AI necessity:** Revisit and sharpen the AI strategy and justification.

Five things AI currently does

1

Generate

Text, code, images, audio.

Good when output is creative; bad when output must be exact.

2

Classify

Sort inputs into categories.

Triage, routing, moderation.
Cheap and reliable.

3

Extract

Pull structured fields from unstructured docs.

PDF invoice → transaction info in database

4

Retrieve

Find the right info in a big dataset.

"What's our return policy?"
→ relevant help doc section

5

Act

Multi-step plans across tools (agents).

Powerful, fragile, expensive. Use sparingly.

Is AI necessary - or bolted on?

Red flags · AI is bolted on

You could replace the AI with a form, a rule, or a search bar and the product would still work.

The AI is the "wow" demo but not the core loop.

Users wouldn't pay any more because there's AI in it.

The failure mode of the AI is acceptable only because nobody is depending on it.

Green flags · AI is load-bearing

Without AI, the experience does not exist (no one would build it pre-2023)

AI does the part that costs the most human time today

AI quality directly drives the metric the user pays for

A non-AI baseline exists and is measurably worse

Fill the canvas before you build anything

It is essential to “plan the build”, then “build the plan”.

0 1

User journey

Current solution process **vs.**
Future process with your AI tool

0 2

Inputs

What the user gives the AI.
Format, source, frequency, volume.

0 3

Outputs

What the AI returns.
Format, confidence, latency, cost.

0 4

Where AI sits

AI in the loop, supporting on the side, or
the entire workflow?

0 5

Non-AI baseline

The same workflow without AI.
Be specific about why it's worse.

0 6

AI necessity

**Why this is impossible (or much worse)
without AI.**

Prototyping & experimentation

1

Plan Architecture & Workflow

Use development environment of choice.

2

Front-end & Back-end Prototypes

A visual prototype of the UI (what the user sees)

and

A functional prototype (what the AI actually does)

3

Balanced Technical and Business Fluency

Business students must understand and prototype the AI logic.

Tech students must understand and develop the value narrative.

Different depth depending on your discipline.

What business students go deep on

User Journey: Typical use case and edge cases.

Narrative: Value and one-sentence product description.

Differentiation: Market and competitor analysis.

Deliver Value: How you demo value (not just features).

Pricing: Implications of latency, cost, and accuracy choices.

What tech students go deep on

Tech Stack: AI primitive selection and tool choice

Prototype Structure: Justified functional backend prototype

Stress Tests & Failure Modes: where/how does it break?

Performance: cost, latency, and accuracy on 5 real examples

UI: What the user sees when AI is wrong or unsure

Tool menu - available to every team member

1

UI mock-up design

60min – 3+ key screens

Figma

Use to demo user experience.

2

No-code prototypes

30min – Initial UI

Bolt, v0.dev, Lovable, Replit.

Visual + working front-end with one prompt.

3

Leverage AI APIs

60min – Initial AI Input

OpenAI, Anthropic, OpenRouter.

APIs allow integration of existing AI models into solution backend.

End-of-day alignment check

The goal is to make sure the visual and the experiment describe the same product.

- Does the front-end prototype reflect what the backend AI does? **Form + Function**
- Are the AI outputs in the prototype realistic - or aspirational? **Appropriate Scope**
- What does the user see when AI is wrong, slow, or unsure? **Error Modes**
- What is the one moment in the demo where AI is visibly impressive? **Value Delivery**
- Can every member say the same one-sentence product description? **Cohesive Team**

END OF DAY 2

Your deliverables: Solution Spec, Model, UI, and Backend

What this looks like:

- 1-page Solution Spec (6-stage Canvas, sharp one-sentence product description, AI architecture)
- Figma model of target front-end & workflow
- *Initial* Functional UI Front-end Prototype (e.g., Bolt, Lovable)
- *Initial* Backend Development and Integration (e.g., Claude, ChatGPT APIs)

IF NOT FINISHED IN CLASS - DUE BEFORE NEXT SESSION

Finalize the Solution Spec & Figma model.
Initial models of UI and AI-enabled Backend.

NEXT WEEK

Day 3: Business - market, model, and risk